

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

Client Relationship Profile

Statewide Health System

CONFIDENTIAL

Version 1.8 | Effective Date: February 2026

Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

This document is the proprietary and confidential property of Meridian & Associates LLP. It is intended solely for the use of the designated recipient(s). Any unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or disclosure of this material is strictly prohibited.

1. Client Overview

Client Name: Statewide Health System

Industry: Healthcare (Integrated Health System)

Headquarters: Columbus, OH

Annual Revenue: \$7.2 billion (FY2025)

Employees: 42,000

Organization Type: Not-for-profit 501(c)(3)

Facilities: 12 hospitals, 85 ambulatory care sites, 3 post-acute facilities, 2 research centers

Service Area: Central and Southern Ohio (3.2 million covered lives)

Fiscal Year End: June 30

Relationship Partner: Michael Torres, CPA, PMP

Relationship Start Date: March 2019

Relationship Tenure: 7 years

2. Relationship History

Meridian's relationship with Statewide Health System began in 2019 when we were selected through a competitive RFP process to provide revenue cycle optimization consulting. The engagement was highly successful, leading to significant relationship expansion. Statewide is now Meridian's largest healthcare client and a flagship reference account for the Healthcare & Life Sciences Practice. Total relationship revenue has grown from \$1.2M in Year 1 to \$11.4M in FY2025.

Timeline of Engagements

- **2019 (Q1):** Revenue Cycle Optimization -- 14-month engagement to redesign patient access, charge capture, coding, and denial management processes across all 12 hospitals. Achieved \$48M annual revenue improvement.
- **2020 (Q2):** COVID-19 Financial Response -- emergency engagement to model financial impact, optimize CARES Act funding, and restructure operating budgets. Secured \$124M in CARES/ARPA funding.
- **2020 (Q4):** Telehealth Strategy -- developed enterprise telehealth strategy and implementation roadmap. Scaled from 200 to 15,000 monthly virtual visits within 6 months.
- **2021 (Q2):** Clinical Workforce Planning -- comprehensive workforce analysis addressing post-pandemic nursing shortages. Developed retention strategies, compensation benchmarking, and flexible staffing models.
- **2022 (Q1):** ERP Advisory Services -- selected as independent advisor for Oracle Cloud implementation (see separate proposal file). 24-month program currently in Phase 3.
- **2023 (Q1):** Value-Based Care Program Design -- designed bundled payment programs for orthopedics, cardiology, and maternity services. Negotiated contracts with 4 major payers.
- **2024 (Q2):** Cybersecurity Assessment -- HITRUST readiness assessment and remediation planning across all clinical and business systems. Achieved HITRUST r2 certification in 10 months.
- **2025 (Q1):** Financial Sustainability Initiative -- comprehensive margin improvement program targeting \$85M in annual savings through operational efficiency, supply chain optimization, and revenue enhancement.

3. Current Active Engagements

ERP Advisory Services (Multi-Year)

Total Contract Value: \$4.8M (24-month program)

Current Phase: Phase 3: Build and Configure (Month 14 of 24)

Meridian Team Size: 12 professionals on-site (1 Program Director, 3 Functional Leads, 2 Change Management, 6 Analysts)

Status: On track -- green on all major milestones

Engagement Partner: Michael Torres

Client Contact: CIO, Robert Patel; CFO, Angela Morrison

Financial Sustainability Initiative (In Progress)

Contract Value: \$3.2M (18-month program)

Current Phase: Phase 2: Implementation (Month 8 of 18)

Target Savings: \$85M annual run-rate by completion

Savings Achieved to Date: \$42M identified, \$28M implemented

Engagement Partner: Michael Torres

Client Contact: CFO, Angela Morrison; COO, Dr. James Patterson

Cybersecurity Managed Services (Ongoing)

Annual Fee: \$1.8M

Scope: Continuous monitoring, vulnerability management, incident response, HITRUST maintenance, security awareness training for 42,000 employees

Engagement Partner: David Kim

Client Contact: CISO, Michelle Chang

Tax-Exempt Bond Compliance (Annual)

Annual Fee: \$380K

Scope: Post-issuance compliance monitoring for \$1.4B in outstanding tax-exempt bonds. Private use analysis, arbitrage rebate calculations.

Engagement Partner: James Worthington

Client Contact: Treasurer, William Foster

4. Key Outcomes and Value Delivered

- **Revenue Cycle:** \$48M annual revenue improvement through denial rate reduction (from 12.4% to 6.8%), coding accuracy improvement (95.2% to 98.7%), and patient access redesign
- **COVID-19 Response:** \$124M in CARES/ARPA funding secured. Financial model guided Board through decisions on service line prioritization and capital expenditure deferrals.
- **Telehealth:** Scaled from 200 to 15,000 monthly virtual visits. Telehealth now accounts for 8% of total ambulatory visits with patient satisfaction scores averaging 4.6/5.0
- **Value-Based Care:** Bundled payment programs generating \$12M in shared savings in Year 1. Quality metrics improved across all three service lines.
- **Cybersecurity:** Achieved HITRUST r2 certification in 10 months (industry average: 14 months). Reduced critical vulnerabilities by 91%.
- **Financial Sustainability:** \$42M in savings opportunities identified in first 8 months against \$85M 18-month target. Ahead of pace.
- **Workforce:** Nursing turnover reduced from 24% to 16% through retention strategies. Saved an estimated \$18M in annual agency staffing costs.

5. Client Satisfaction

Most Recent CSAT Score: 4.8 / 5.0 (November 2025 annual survey)

Net Promoter Score: +82 (Promoter category -- highest among healthcare clients)

Relationship Health Rating: Green -- flagship account

Selected verbatim feedback from the CEO:

- 'Meridian is a true strategic partner. They understand the unique challenges of running a not-for-profit health system and bring insights from across their client base that we simply cannot get elsewhere.'
- 'Michael Torres and his team operate with an ownership mentality. They care about our outcomes as much as we do.'
- 'The breadth of capabilities -- from ERP to cybersecurity to financial strategy -- under one roof has been transformational for us.'

6. Growth Opportunities

- **External Financial Audit:** Current auditor contract expires June 2027. Board Audit Committee chair has expressed interest in exploring alternatives. Requires independence review.
- **Clinical AI Advisory:** Statewide is evaluating AI-assisted clinical decision support, ambient documentation, and predictive analytics. RFP expected Q3 2026.
- **Ambulatory Growth Strategy:** Planning 8 new ambulatory sites over 3 years. Opportunity for market analysis, site selection, and financial pro forma development.
- **Post-Acute Care Expansion:** Exploring home health and hospice service lines. Advisory opportunity for market entry strategy and regulatory compliance.

7. Key Contacts at Statewide Health

- **CEO:** Dr. Catherine Reynolds (relationship: strong -- quarterly executive meetings)
- **CFO:** Angela Morrison (relationship: very strong -- weekly interaction)
- **CIO:** Robert Patel (relationship: strong -- daily interaction during ERP program)
- **COO:** Dr. James Patterson (relationship: strong -- financial sustainability program)
- **CISO:** Michelle Chang (relationship: strong)
- **CMO:** Dr. Elizabeth Warren (relationship: developing)
- **Board Audit Committee Chair:** Harold Richardson (relationship: moderate -- annual presentation)